Design Justification - KampüsAjanda

1. Introduction

KampüsAjanda is a mobile application for Yıldız Technical University (YTÜ) students. It recommends campus events that fit each student's free time and interests, and lets students join events and keep their classes and events in one calendar. Student clubs use a separate panel inside the same app to create and manage their events.
Our main design goals were a simple and consistent interface, a short path to the most common task (finding an event that fits the student's schedule), and screens that stay readable for everyone.

2. Color Palette

We chose dark navy blue as the main color of our application because it is also associated with Yıldız Technical University. We wanted our application to have a visual connection with the university.
Pink is our second color for two reasons: it balances the navy and makes the design warmer, and it echoes the pink flowers in the campus photo on our welcome screen.
We also used different shades of pink in the backgrounds to create a soft look. White and gray tones were preferred to keep the screens simple and make the content easier to read.

Role	Color	Where we use it
Primary (navy)	#12284A	Headers, main buttons, selected tab, text on pink
Secondary (pink)	#D0B5BB	Main button on the welcome screen, highlights
Backgrounds	#F3DDE2, #F8EEF1, #E8EEF8	Screen background gradient
Cards	#FFFFFF	Event cards, forms, bottom sheets
Gray	#D4D4D4, #5F5F5F	Borders, dividers, inactive icons, secondary text
Status (text/ background)	green: #17703A/ #E6F4EA yellow: #8A5A00/ #FFF4D6 red: #C62828 / #FDECEC	"Fits your free time", "Partly fits", "Conflicts with a class" badges
Warning	#FBA7A7	Offline warning banner

3. Typography

We chose Inter as the main font for our application because we wanted a simple, modern and easy-to-read design. We used different font weights depending on the importance of the text.
Inter Bold: We mainly used it for page titles and headings that we wanted to stand out.
Inter Regular: We used it for descriptions and general text throughout the application.
Inter Semi Bold: We used it in some subheadings and areas that needed slightly more emphasis than regular text.
We used larger text for titles and smaller text for labels and dates, so the difference between them is easy to see while all text stays readable.

4. Layout and UI Design

The student side has three main screens: For You (06), Calendar (08) and Profile (09). A bottom navigation bar connects them, because these are the sections students use every day and they should always be one tap away. Events are shown as cards with an image, time, place and a match percentage, so students can compare events quickly while scrolling.
The club side is a separate Club Panel (10) with its own tabs for the panel and the club's events (12). It uses the same colors, cards and fonts as the student side, so it feels like part of the same app. A “Back to student view” button returns to the student screens.

The design is responsive. On a tablet in landscape (13), a side navigation rail replaces the bottom bar, and the event list and event details are shown side by side. This uses the extra width instead of stretching the phone layout.

5. User Experience

While designing KampüsAjanda, we wanted to make it useful for both students and student clubs.
Recommendations that fit the schedule: After sign-up, students choose at least 3 interests (04) and enter their weekly timetable (05). The For You screen then ranks events by how well they fit the student's free time and interests, and each card explains why with a short label such as “Fits your free time”.
Reminders: Students can turn on a reminder on the event detail screen (07). The default is 1 day before the event, because 79% of our survey participants chose this option.
Weather for outdoor events: Outdoor events (07.1) use the same detail screen with an extra weather row, so students can decide whether to go.
Offline use: Without internet, the For You screen (06.1) shows the last saved events with a warning banner, so the app is still useful on campus where the connection is weak.
One account for everyone: All users sign up with their university e-mail. A club officer activates the club panel from Profile with a one-time code from SKS (09.1). This keeps the sign-up process simple and means clubs never share a password. Student clubs can use their own panels to create and manage events (11), making it easier for them to share their activities with students. Each club can be managed by up to three officers, and the management can be handed over to another person later (10.1).
Fewer errors: Wrong log-in details, an invalid club code or missing fields on the event form show a clear message and keep the user on the same screen.

6. Accessibility

We aimed to make the interface simple, clear and easy to use. We used different font weights to distinguish headings from descriptions and maintained a consistent color palette throughout the screens. We also organized the content into separate cards and sections to help users follow the information more easily.
We checked our main color combinations against the WCAG AA standard, which requires a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1 for normal text. White text on the navy background (#12284A) has a ratio of 14.7:1, and navy text on the pink buttons (#D0B5BB) has a ratio of 7.7:1. Navy text on our light backgrounds also passes easily: 11.4:1 on #F3DDE2, 12.9:1 on #F8EEF1 and 12.6:1 on #E8EEF8. All of these meet the required level. All status badges pass WCAG AA (green 5.4:1, yellow 5.4:1, red 4.9:1).
We did not use white text on pink backgrounds because its contrast ratio is only 1.9:1, which is insufficient.

We also applied the following design decisions to improve accessibility:
Touch targets: We designed buttons to be at least 48 px tall. We also provided a 48 × 48 px tap area for small icons and chips.
Color usage: We did not rely on color alone to communicate meaning. Selected interest chips also include a ✓ symbol, and match badges include descriptive text, so the status colors (green, yellow, red) can be understood without seeing the color.
Text on photos: We added a dark navy layer behind text placed over photos to keep it readable.
Text size: We used different text sizes to show the importance of the content: larger sizes for titles, medium sizes for main content, and smaller sizes for labels, dates and badges. Small text always relies on clear wording rather than color alone.

7. Conclusion

Overall, we designed KampüsAjanda to give students a simple and practical way to follow campus activities, and to help clubs manage their events. We combined a university-inspired navy and pink palette, Inter typography and card-based screens to create a consistent design. Key features such as schedule-based recommendations, reminders, offline support and a tablet layout come from students' daily needs. The result is a simple app that helps students find events that fit their week and helps clubs reach them.